

I. Introduction

The primary goal of this activity was to transform raw business data into actionable geographic insights using Looker Studio. By implementing two distinct types of visualizations—a Choropleth (Filled) Map and an Interactive Google Maps Bubble Visualization—the project aimed to demonstrate how spatial data can reveal regional performance trends that are often hidden in standard tabular reports.

II. Methodology

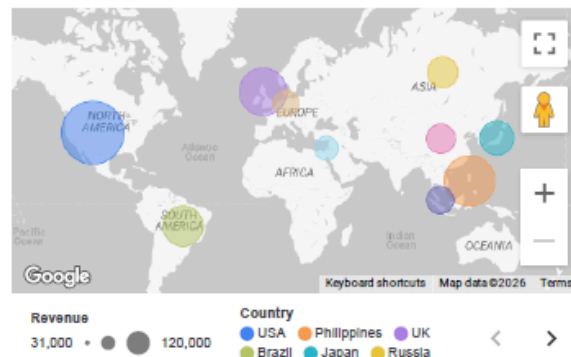
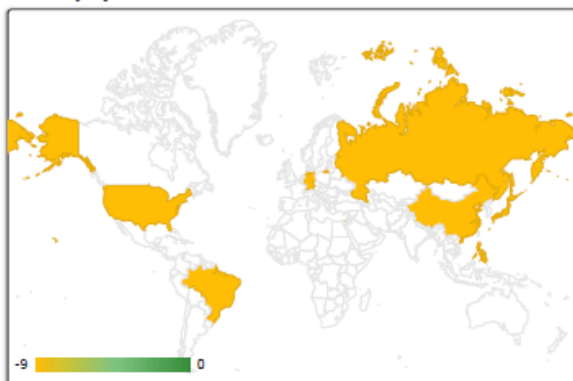
To bring this workshop to life, the following technical steps were performed:

- **Data Acquisition:** Two identical datasets were utilized to test the effects of data schema configurations on map rendering.
- **Environment Setup:** The datasets were connected to Looker Studio. One source was kept with default settings, while the second was modified via the **Resources** tab to explicitly change the "Country" field from a *Text* type to a *Geo* -> *Country* data type.
- **Visualization Construction:**
 - **Filled Map:** Created by mapping the "Country" dimension to the geographic field and assigning a metric (Revenue) to the color scale.
 - **Bubble Map:** Integrated using the Google Maps chart type, where bubble size was dictated by Revenue and colors were assigned based on the specific Country.

3. Visual Documentation

The implementation resulted in a functional dashboard.

Country by Revenue



4. Problem-Solving

Throughout the activity, several technical challenges were encountered and resolved:

- **Data Type Mismatch:** Initially, the Filled Map would not render because Looker Studio requires a specific "Geo" data type.
 - *Solution:* Tinkered with the **Manage added data sources** settings to manually override the field type from *Text* to *Country*.
- **Cross-Filtering Confusion:** A significant challenge occurred when enabling chart interactions. Selecting a country on the Filled Map caused the rest of the visualization to become transparent, making it look "baseless."
 - *Adjustment:* Refined the interaction settings and learned that this transparency is a native Looker Studio behavior to highlight selected data; adjusted the "Style" settings to ensure the background map remained visible for context.

5. Conclusion

This activity successfully demonstrated the power of localized data visualization. While the learning curve for Looker Studio's geographic settings was steep at first, the resulting interactive dashboard proves that such tools are indispensable for large-scale business operations. The ability to see Revenue density at a glance—from the USA to the Philippines—provides a much higher level of data literacy than traditional spreadsheets.